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WHAT IS MY MARYLAND HOME WORTH?

THE COMPLETE MARYLAND
HOME VALUATION GUIDE

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WHAT IS MY MARYLAND HOME WORTH?

The Complete Maryland Home Valuation Guide

How to understand your home's true market value, what buyers are actually willing to pay, and why the right price is about more than an online estimate.

You've Probably Seen Several Different Numbers

If You've Searched "How Much Is My House Worth?"

Zillow Says One Thing

Redfin says another. A neighbor's house sold for a certain amount.

Your Tax Assessment Shows Something Different

And you may have an agent telling you your home could be worth even more. So which number is right?

The Answer: None of Them Automatically

Your home's value isn't a single number sitting in a database.

What Your Home Is Actually Worth

It's an estimate of what a qualified buyer is likely willing to pay for your specific property, in your specific market, under current conditions. That requires data, context, experience, and strategy.





WHAT DOES "MARKET VALUE" ACTUALLY MEAN?

Chapter 1 of 8

When real estate professionals talk about a home's market value, they're generally trying to answer a simple question: "What would a reasonable buyer likely pay for this property today?"

That Number Is Influenced by Several Things

Happening at the Same Time

Your Property

Size, bedrooms, bathrooms, condition, age, layout, renovations, basement, garage, lot size

Your Location

Neighborhood, school district, roads, nearby amenities, views, privacy, surrounding properties, local demand

The Current Market

Competing homes, recent sales, buyer demand, interest rates, inventory, days on market

Why Similar Homes Sell for Different Prices

That's why two homes that look similar on paper can sell for very different prices. The combination of property, location, and market conditions creates a unique value for every home.





HOW IS A MARYLAND HOME'S VALUE DETERMINED?

It Starts With Comparable Sales

A professional home valuation typically starts with comparable sales, often called "comps." These are properties similar enough to yours to provide useful evidence about what buyers are paying.

Location

Neighborhood & School District

A home a few streets away may not be a true comparable if in a different market area.

Size

Square Footage & Layout

A 2,500 sq ft home with excellent layout competes differently from one with awkward floor plan.

Condition

Renovations & Maintenance

A completely renovated property may command a premium compared with one needing work.

Features

Lot, Land & Extras

Garages, finished basements, pools, barns, views, waterfront, and acreage affect value.

Key insight: Choosing comps isn't as simple as searching for three houses with the same number of bedrooms. The best comparables are similar in the ways that matter.

The Market Changes. So Should the Analysis.

Sale Date Matters

A comparable that sold many months ago may not accurately represent today's market.

What They Adjust For

Age & Style

Newer vs. older construction appeal

What Requires Context

Sale Date

Market conditions shift over time

Comparable analysis requires adjustment and context. That's why a professional valuation goes beyond simply averaging three nearby sales.



WHY ONLINE ESTIMATES CAN BE WRONG

Online Estimates Are Useful but Easy to Misunderstand

Automated valuation models use large amounts of property and market data to generate an estimated value. The problem is that an algorithm may not fully understand what makes your individual property different.

What an Algorithm Knows vs. What It Misses

What It Knows

4 bedrooms, 2.5 bathrooms, 2,400 square feet, year built, lot size, tax records, recent nearby sales

What It May Miss

Renovated kitchen, new roof, finished basement, private wooded lot, detached garage, difficult floor plan, deferred maintenance, exceptional view

An online estimate is a starting point, not a listing strategy. Use it to understand the general range, not as the definitive answer.

Your Tax Assessment Isn't Your Market Value

They Serve Different Purposes

Tax Assessment

Used for property taxation
Not updated frequently
May lag behind market
Different methodology

Market Value

Based on:

What a buyer may reasonably pay today
Current market evidence and conditions
Comparable recent sales
Don't price based on your tax assessment





THE 7 BIGGEST FACTORS THAT AFFECT VALUE

While Every Property Is Different, These Factors Frequently Have a Major Impact

Location, size & layout, condition, renovations & improvements, lot & land, competition, and market conditions. These seven factors determine what buyers are willing to pay for your home.

Location vs. Condition: Two Key Drivers

1. Location

You can't renovate your way into a different location.

Neighborhood & schools

Commute & roads

Shopping & restaurants

Parks & amenities

Privacy & surroundings

3. Condition

Buyers don't just buy square footage. They buy condition.

Roof & HVAC

Windows & plumbing

Kitchen & bathrooms

Flooring & paint

Exterior & basement

The question isn't "How much did I spend?" It's "How much more will a buyer actually pay because of it?" Not every dollar spent on renovation translates into a dollar of increased value.





WHAT ARE YOUR COMPS ACTUALLY TELLING YOU?

Think of Comps in Three Categories

Sold Properties

These tell you what buyers actually paid. Usually the strongest evidence of completed market transactions.

Pending Properties

Insight into what buyers are currently willing to pay, although final sale price may not yet be known.

Active Listings

Show what you're competing against. But an active listing is an asking price, not proof of value.

A Simple Example

Home A: \$475,000 | Home B: \$490,000 | Home C: \$505,000. Your home may not be worth the average of those three.

Why Context Matters

Home A Needed a New Roof

A major repair need can significantly reduce what buyers are willing to pay compared to move-in ready homes.

Home B Was Fully Renovated

A completely updated property commands a premium that may not apply to your home if yours needs work.

Home C Had a Larger Lot & Finished Basement

Additional features like extra land or finished space add value that may not transfer to your property.

The Takeaway

Comparable analysis requires adjustment and context. Not all comps are equally useful for determining your value.



WHAT SHOULD YOU FIX BEFORE SELLING?

Don't Spend Money on the Wrong Improvements

You don't want to spend \$40,000 preparing a home that only generates \$15,000 of additional buyer value. Before making improvements, divide them into three categories.

Three Categories of Pre-Sale Improvements

Category 1: Must Fix

Active leaks, major safety issues, broken systems, obvious structural problems, significant deferred maintenance.

Category 2: Strongly Consider

Interior paint, landscaping, lighting, flooring repairs, deep cleaning, decluttering, minor kitchen improvements.

Category 3: Probably Not Worth It

Highly Personalized Renovations

Luxury upgrades that don't fit the neighborhood or major remodeling projects immediately before selling.

Expensive Additions Without Clear Demand

If there isn't clear buyer demand for the improvement, the expected return may not justify the cost.

Before Spending Money, Ask:

"What problem am I solving?" If there isn't a clear answer, the improvement may not be necessary.

The Right Question to Ask

Not "How much did I spend?" but "How much more will a buyer actually pay because of it?"

Key insight: A renovation can help if it improves functionality, addresses buyer objections, brings the property in line with competing homes, or removes obvious deferred maintenance.



WHY PRICING YOUR HOME CORRECTLY MATTERS

Valuation Becomes Strategy

There Is a Difference Between Market Value and Listing Strategy

Your Listing Price Should Consider

Estimated value, competition, buyer demand, recent sales, timeline, condition, unique features, inventory

The Danger of Pricing Too High

Many sellers think: "Let's start high and see what happens." It sounds reasonable. But the market gives you feedback quickly.

If your home is priced too high: fewer buyers click, fewer buyers tour, your days on market increase, you may have to reduce the price, and you can lose negotiating leverage.

What Happens When You Price Too High

Fewer Buyers Click

Your property may receive less online attention. The wrong price can prevent showings before buyers ever see the home.

Days on Market Increase

Buyers begin asking why the home hasn't sold. A later price reduction can create a perception that something is wrong.

You Lose Negotiating Leverage

Instead of negotiating from a position of demand, you may eventually be negotiating from a position of urgency.

The Goal

The goal isn't to be the most expensive home. It's to be the home buyers believe is worth choosing.

Chapter 7 of 8

The highest possible listing price isn't always the best strategy.
The right strategy starts with understanding the evidence.
Then we build the plan around your goals.

Kyle Friedman | The Friedman Team | eXp Realty





HOW MUCH WILL YOU ACTUALLY WALK AWAY WITH?

Your Estimated Net Proceeds

Your Home's Value Is Only One Part of the Equation

A Simplified Example

Estimated Sale Price: \$600,000 | Less Mortgage: -\$250,000 | Less Expenses: -\$XX,XXX

The Number That Matters Most to You

The exact numbers depend on your property, loan, transaction, contract terms, taxes, fees, and other circumstances.

A good home valuation should go beyond "Your house is worth \$600,000." It should help answer: "If we sold around \$600,000, what might you actually walk away with?"

The Difference Between Price & Value

1. What You Want

The price you'd ideally like to receive for your home.

2. What You Need

The amount you need to accomplish your next financial or personal goal.

3. What the Market Supports

What qualified buyers are realistically willing to pay. These numbers aren't always the same.

Your Realtor's Job

It's to help you understand the market and build a strategy around the numbers, not tell you what you want to hear.

Chapter 8 of 8

Your home is one of the largest financial assets you own.
You deserve to understand what it's worth before deciding.
Let's start with the numbers.



YOUR MARYLAND HOME VALUE CHECKLIST

Before Deciding What Your Home Is Worth

Consider These Questions First

Property Questions

Square feet, bedrooms, bathrooms, age, condition, renovations, systems, basement, garage, lot size

5 Common Home Valuation Mistakes

Avoid these errors when trying to determine what your home is worth in today's market.

Pricing based on what you paid. Using your neighbor's sale as the answer. Adding up renovation costs. Trusting an online estimate completely. Pricing based on what you need.

Location & Market Questions

Location

Neighborhood, school district, accessibility, nearby amenities, location advantages or disadvantages

Market

Similar homes recently sold, current competition, how quickly comps are selling, price trends, inventory

Financial

Estimated market value, mortgage balance, estimated selling costs, repairs worth making, net proceeds

The Key Takeaway

The market determines value, not what you paid, what you spent, or what you need. Look at current evidence.

Your Maryland Home Value Checklist

Your home is one of your largest financial assets.
Understand the numbers before making a decision.

Kyle Friedman | The Friedman Team | eXp Realty





THE FRIEDMAN APPROACH TO HOME VALUATION

More Than a Number. A Strategy.

At The Friedman Team, a home valuation isn't simply about putting a number on your property. It's about understanding why that number makes sense.

We Look At

The Property

What makes your home different?
What features add value?
What condition is it in?
What would buyers notice?

The Market

What are buyers actually doing?
What homes are they considering?
How quickly are things selling?
What trends are emerging?

The Opportunity & The Numbers

The Opportunity

What can we do to improve your home's position? What improvements are worth making before listing?

The Numbers

What could your estimated net proceeds look like? What would you actually walk away with?

The Competition

What other homes are buyers considering? Why would a buyer choose yours over the alternatives?

Your Home Doesn't Need to Be Perfect

It needs to be positioned correctly.

The highest possible listing price isn't always the best strategy. The right strategy starts with understanding the evidence. Then we build the plan around your goals.



GET YOUR FREE MARYLAND HOME VALUATION

Find Out What Your Home Could Be Worth Today

If you're thinking about selling or simply curious about your home's current value, let's take a look at the numbers.

Your Complimentary Home Valuation & Seller Strategy Session

What Comparable Homes Are Selling For

What your home could realistically be worth and how your property features affect value.

How You Compare With Competition

What improvements may be worth making and how to position your property for the current market.

What You Could Walk Away With

Estimated Selling Costs

What your estimated selling costs could look like and what you could potentially walk away with.

Market Positioning Strategy

How to position your property for the current market to attract qualified buyers.

No Pressure. No Obligation.

Just a clear picture of where you stand.

Ready to Find Out What Your Maryland Home Is Worth?

Request your Free Home Valuation & Seller Strategy Session today.

Kyle Friedman | The Friedman Team | eXp Realty
Call or Text: 443-789-3101 | Email: Kyle@friedmanreteam.com



A FINAL WORD FROM KYLE

Your Home Is One of Your Largest Financial Assets

You deserve to understand what it's worth before making a decision about selling. Whether you're thinking about selling next month, next year, or you're simply curious about how the market has affected your home's value, knowing the numbers gives you options. I don't believe homeowners should be pressured into selling. I believe they should have the information necessary to make a smart decision.

Kyle Friedman

The Friedman Team | eXp Realty



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Let's start with the numbers. More Than a Listing. A Strategy. Maryland Real Estate | Residential | Farms | Land | Luxury & Country Properties. Request your Free Home Valuation & Seller Strategy Session.

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